Official Community Plan

Phase 2

Engagement Summary
October 2024

CITY OF SURREY

Where We Are

Introduction

The Official Community Plan (OCP) is one of the City's most important documents. It holds our vision for the City's future and the tools to help guide growth and development. As we update the plan, we are looking for your input to help shape key elements.

In Phase 1 engagement we asked residents what they love about Surrey and what are the biggest challenges the City is facing. In Phase 2 we asked residents what are the most important values and building blocks that should guide the City as it grows. These elements will help shape the vision for the City.

What We Did

Phase 2: Visioning

Engagement for Phase 2 began in June 2024 and focused on identifying core community values and "building blocks" that will help guide the growth of the City. Values are key beliefs and/or principles. Building blocks are the City's long-range growth and development priorities, that will be focused on over the next five years. Engagement in Phase 2 involved a community survey, pop-up engagement, and a "Big Ideas" section on our online engagement page.

By The Numbers...

There are approximately 610,000 residents within Surrey. Here's a breakdown of people that were engaged or informed in the Phase 2 exploration of OCP update.

Approximately,

8,500+ Engaged Residents

An engaged resident is defined as an individual or group that has contributed to the project website, attended a pop-up event, connected through phone or email, completed the survey or attended a stakeholder meeting.

Residents were engaged through:

- **3,100+** Surveys Completed & Questions Asked
- **5,300+** Pop-Up Event Attendees
- **100+** Website Contributions, Emails & Phone Calls

Approximately,

19,800+ Informed Residents

An informed resident is defined as an individual or group that has made at least one single visit to the project website, or interacted with the project through social media.

Residents were informed through:

- **12,200+** Website Page Views
- **1,500+** eNews Interactions
- **6,160+** Social Media Interactions*
  *clicks, reactions, comments, and shares

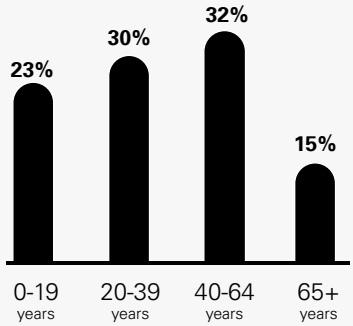
Who We Reached

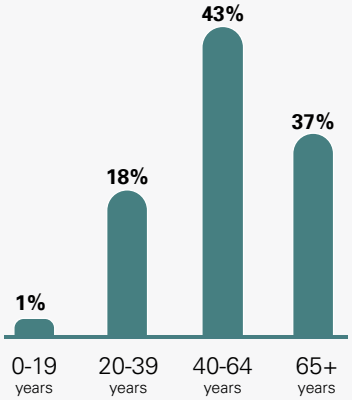
Our goal is to ensure we hear from a balanced and diverse range of residents in Surrey. Below is a profile of the City of Surrey compared with a profile of who we reached in this survey. By understanding who we've reached, we can better understand who we have not yet heard from and who we may still need to reach out to. Through the ongoing planning process, we will continue to seek out underrepresented residents.

Community Profile

Survey Respondents

Age





Tenure

30% Rent **70%** Own

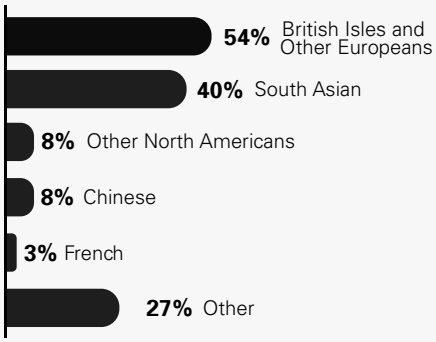
15% Rent **85%** Own

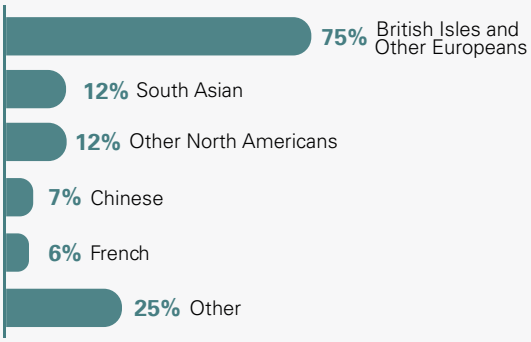
Income

Less than $30,000	**9%**
$30,000 to less than $59,999	**18%**
$60,000 to less than $99,999	**25%**
$100,000 to less than $149,999	**23%**
$150,000 or more	**26%**

Less than $30,000	**7%**
$30,000 to less than $59,999	**17%**
$60,000 to less than $99,999	**26%**
$100,000 to less than $149,999	**25%**
$150,000 or more	**25%**

Ethnicity





A | Community Survey

What We Heard

Identifying Values

Values are key beliefs or principles. As part of the OCP update, we want to identify the core values we should use to guide growth in the City. The last OCP had the following values – greener, complete, compact, connected, resilient, safer, inclusive, healthier, and beautiful.

Possible values listed in the survey are ***livable, equity, zero carbon, reconciliation, affordable, saftey, resilience and biodiversity.*** These values are used in other city and regional planning documents that were developed with comprehensive public engagement.

1a. We asked participants to select up to five values that are the most important for guiding growth in the City. (3,138 responses)

Top responses included:

82% Safety

80% Livable

70% Affordable

65% Biodiversity

47% Resilience

Other responses included:

42% Equity

25% Zero Carbon

16% Reconciliation

1b. For those who chose other, we asked them to please specify. (218 responses)

Key themes that emerged:

- Need for improvements to essential services.
- Reliable, integrated public transit system.
- Adequate schools for growing population.
- Safe neighborhoods free from crime.
- Emphasis on creating better job opportunities.
- Preserve identity with community spaces and livable neighborhoods.

Refining the Building Blocks

Building blocks are what we are calling the City's long range growth and development priorities. Over the next five years, we aim to focus on these priorities. They're based on what residents highlighted in Phase 1 engagement, along with current City and regional priorities. The building blocks will provide the foundation for the policies that will be developed later in the process.

Here are the five draft building blocks:

1 Housing for All.

2 A Thriving and Diverse Economy.

3 A Vibrant Downtown.

4 Livable, Equitable, Connected Neighbourhoods.

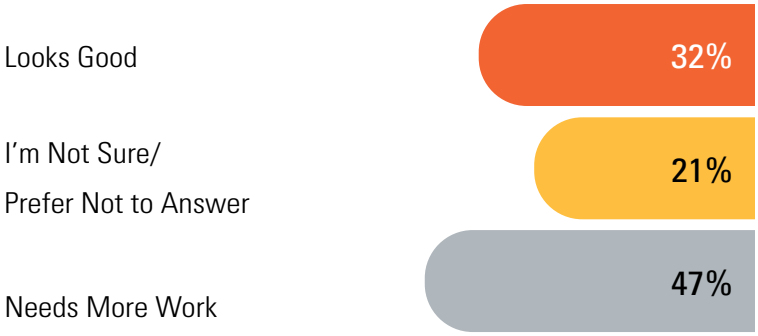
5 A Healthy Environment and Zero Carbon City.

Building Block 1: Housing for All

Surrey is the fastest growing city in BC with second largest population after Vancouver. This rapid growth has made housing less affordable, harder to find and increased homelessness. All residents should have safe and affordable housing that includes everything from temporary emergency shelters through to transition and supportive housing, subsidized and,market rental housing, or market homeownership.

1a. We asked participants if we are on the right track with Building Block 1 – Housing for all. (2,927 responses)

32%
said "Looks Good".



1b. For those who said, "Needs more work", we asked what they would change or add to the building block. (1,369 responses)

Key themes that emerged:

- Demand for more affordable housing options.
- Need for infrastructure to support rapid growth.
- Emphasis on expediting the development process.
- Emphasis on providing incentives to homeless population.
- Provision small scale housing with multiple units.
- Support for creating high density developments while maintaining the neighbourhood character.

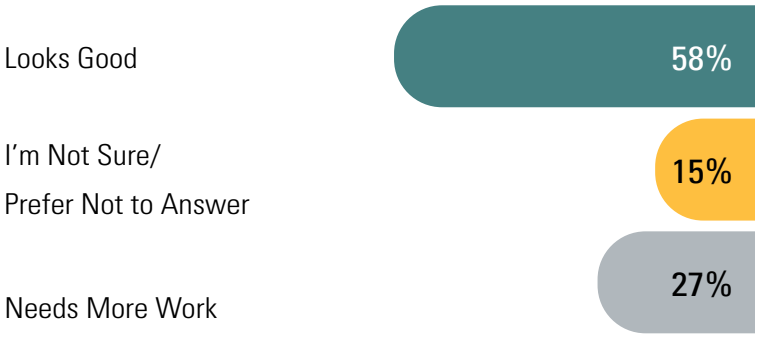
> *"More affordable housing without sacrificing needed green spaces."*
>
> *"The homeless population needs a broader range of assistance."*
>
> *"The ability of the surrounding roads and schools to keep up with the building must be addressed."*
>
> *"Multi-dwelling homes that are walkable, bike friendly, and accessible to transit. As well as providing access to more equitable and urban green spaces."*

Building Block 2: A Thriving and Diverse Economy

A growing City needs to consider employment in addition to housing. A thriving and diverse economy is one that has jobs in a variety of sectors across the City. One of the City's economic goals is to create one job for every resident worker in Surrey.

2a. We asked participants if we are on the right track with Building Block 2 – A thriving and diverse economy. (2,816 responses)

58%
said "Looks Good".



2b. For those who said, "Needs more work", we asked what they would change or add to the building block. (750 responses)

Key themes that emerged:

- Ensure protection of Agricultural Land Reserve.
- Prioritize development of essential services such as roads, schools, hospitals and public transit.
- Support for small, local and diverse businesses.
- Enhance local job opportunities.
- Ensure availability of affordable housing and commercial spaces.
- Suggestions to promote industrial development while preserving agricultural land for local food production.

> *"Food security is going to be of the utmost importance in years to come. We must insure our ALR remains intact and possibly reclaim any ALR lands that are presently being used for other purposes."*
>
> *"The employment needs to be better connected with transportation"*
>
> *"Encourage more corporate headquarters to relocate to Surrey."*
>
> *"Create incentives for small and unique businesses in local communities."*

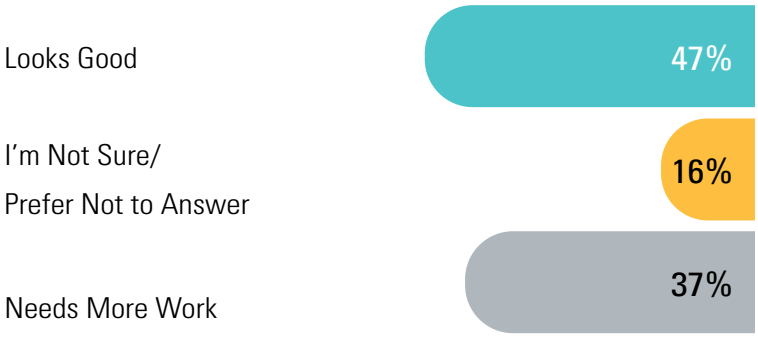
Building Block 3: A vibrant downtown

Metro Vancouver's Regional Growth Strategy identifies Surrey City Centre as the region's second downtown. Over the past decade Surrey City Centre has grown considerably, and a downtown is beginning to emerge. Thriving vibrant urban centres have a mix of residential and employment uses, along with parks and public places, and arts and culture spaces. These spaces compliment each other.

3a. We asked participants if we are on the right track with Building Block 3 – A vibrant downtown. (2,772 responses)

47%

said "Looks Good".



3b. For those who said, "Needs more work", we asked what they would change or add to the building block. (1,018 responses)

Key themes that emerged:

- Ensure that public spaces, including sidewalks and areas around transit stations, are regularly cleaned and maintained.
- Provision for adequate green space in high rise developments.
- Improve safety measures in downtown core.
- Enhancing cultural, entertainment and recreation facilities that are accessible to all.
- Bring variety of shopping brands and retail stores to Downtown.
- Make downtown more walkable and accessible with maintained pathways and sidewalks.

"Priority for green space in high density areas."

"Better boulevards with wider sidewalks. More street beautification."

"Encourage commercial development and residential development with good public transportation connections to reduce travel times and costs."

"More entertainment & dining options. Restaurants, lounges, bars, etc."

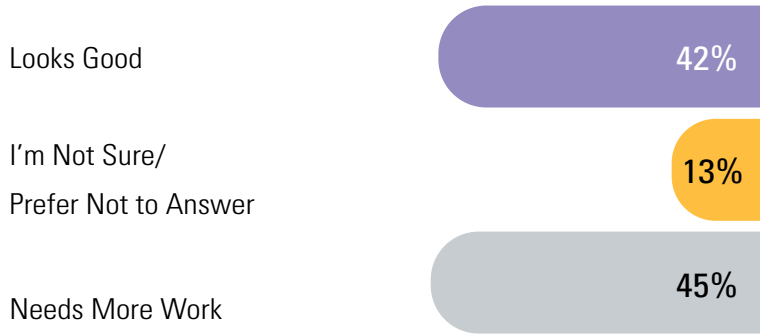
"There needs to be areas where people can live, work and enjoy arts and culture."

Building Block 4: Livable, equitable, and connected neighbourhoods

Surrey is divided into six communities (Whalley, Guildford, Newton, Fleetwood, Cloverdale and South Surrey). Each covers a large geographic area. When we are thinking of complete and livable neighbourhoods, we are thinking about something much smaller in size. These neighbourhoods would include a mix of housing types and daily needs (employment, amenities, services) all within a 15-20 minute walk.

4a. We asked participants if we are on the right track with Building Block 4 – Livable, equitable, and connected neighbourhoods. (2,730 responses)

42%
said "Looks Good".



4b. For those who said, "Needs more work", we asked what they would change or add to the building block. (1,234 responses)

Key themes that emerged:

- More walking and biking options and a better quality experience.
- More and higher quality transit. More frequent transit service and availability.
- More car infrastructure and wider roads to address traffic concerns.
- More commercial amenities, recreation amenities, and schools in the communities.
- Concerns abut safety and lighting in their communities.
- More parks, green space, trees, and protected natural areas in communities..

"Better transportation options like separated bike lanes (not painted) and frequent/convenient transit. Mixed use zoning is easier to walk in. Less cars."

"You need to add parks, schools, libraries and community centers within your livable and connected communities."

"Better safety with the Skytrain coming this way. More sidewalks vs gravel on the sides of roads."

"Increase safety so people can walk to more places."

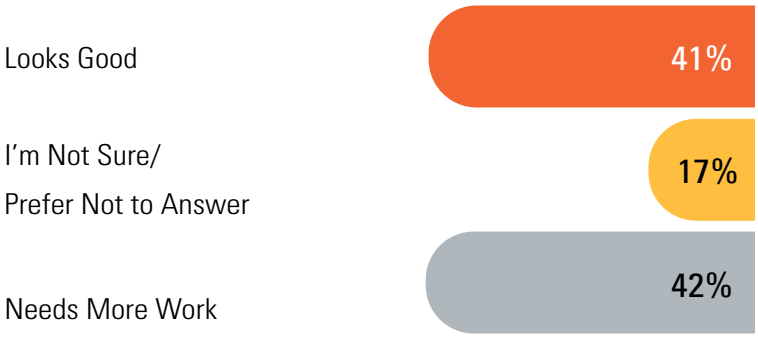
"More Green Spaces needed!!"

Building Block 5: A healthy environment and zero carbon city

Global warming has led to rising sea levels, intensifying heat waves, more frequent and devastating wildfires, and increasingly powerful storms and floods. In 2023 the City endorsed the Climate Change Action Strategy. This strategy includes strong, science-based targets to lower community greenhouse gas emissions to net-zero by 2050.

5a. We asked participants if we are on the right track with Building Block 5 – A healthy environment and zero carbon city. (2,710 responses)

41%
said "Looks Good".



5b. For those who said, "Needs more work", we asked what they would change or add to the building block. (1,129 responses)

Key themes that emerged:

- More greenery in communities.
- More walking and biking infrastructure.
- Better transit options with more frequency.
- Wider roads and more provisions for traffic congestion.
- Implementation of sustainable building design standards and regulations.
- Provision for government incentives for electric cars and sustainable home or business upgrades.

"Add in more sidewalks for walking, more bike lines for biking and more options for public transit."

"Better planning of green zones and keeping existing trees where possible."

"More EV charging stations, alternate power to reduce greenhouse emissions for public buildings"

"Increase safety so people can walk to more places."

"Policies around trees and development."

B | Pop-Up Engagement

Pop-Up Engagement

"Pop-up" engagement is a style of engagement that utilizes a light-touch approach to traditional open house engagement. Where a traditional open house is often a large event with many staff and materials, a pop-up is a smaller installation with less staff and minimal materials.

Our Pop-up engagement setup in Phase 2 consisted of a tent with a spinning trivia wheel, a large vinyl map of Surrey, and information display boards. Attendees to the pop-ups would spin the wheel and answer trivia questions about Surrey; they would then be invited to place a sticker on the map indicating where they live. Additionally, information boards were displayed within the tent to inform attendees about Phase 2 engagement and its content.

The pop-ups were intended to be fun, educational, and seed interesting conversations about where people live, what role their city plays in their lives, and how the City should grow in the future.

Two pop-up campaigns were held for Phase 2.

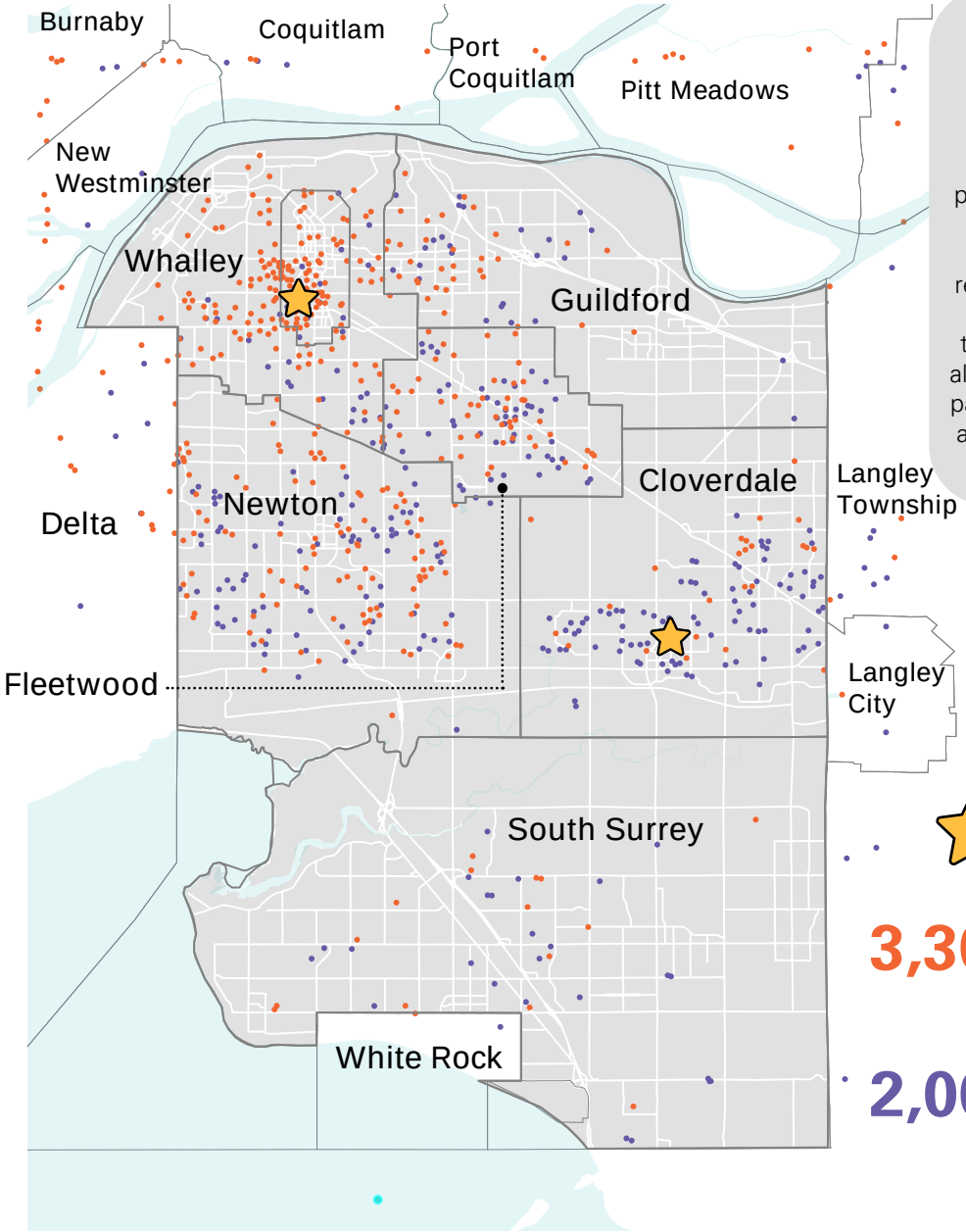
Canada Day Pop-Up

Surrey Fusion Festival Pop-Up

Pop-up Participation

Three pop-up events were held between June and July 2024. Two pop-ups were held at Holland Park at Surrey Fusion Fest and one pop-up event was held at Bill Reid Millennium Amphitheatre on Canada Day. These gatherings allowed us to connect with the community where they were and fostered a lively atmosphere for engagement, featuring a variety of activities. There were:

- **700+** Trivia Questions Answered
- **760+** Pins on Map
- **5,000+** Treats Shared
- **10+** Surrey Staff Involved



Mapping Activity

We asked participants to identify where they live on the map. This activity was added for participants to reflect on their relationship with nearby parks, schools, recreational spaces, and transit with respect to there living locations. It also helped us to identify participants coming from all over Surrey and even outside Surrey.

Locations of the Pop-Up Events

3,300 Attendees on Fusion Festival Pop-Up

2,000 Attendees on Canada Day Pop-Up

C | Big Ideas

Big Ideas

Our online engagement page, surrey.ca/ocp, hosted a Big Ideas tool that allowed participants to add their ideas for the OCP update and Surrey's future growth. Participants were able to "like" idea posts indicating their level of agreement. Participants contributed to 118 ideas and below are the sample of suggestions shared:

*"I hope Surrey's city council will update their Climate Change Action Strategy and consider **global warming** promptly for the new OCP. "*

*"Increase **community kitchens and gardens**."*

*"**Car-free** City."*

*"Promote urban **Agriculture.**"*

*"Proactive measures in the OCP to reduce wealth inequality can **create a more equitable Surrey** with opportunities for all residents."*

*"Regulate or activate programs for food businesses and restaurants to **minimize food-related carbon emissions.**"*

*"Create a **plastic free** city."*

*"**Public Washrooms** at the Clayton SkyTrain stops and bus loops."*

*"**Less parking**, actually."*

Below are some of the photos submitted by participants to illustrate their "Big Ideas" for Surrey's future.

Promoting more Car free days in the City of Surrey and reflecting on the importance of pedestrian friendly zones.

Regulating greenhouse gas emissions in the City of Surrey to prevent climate changes such as coral bleaching and ocean acidification.

Promoting urban agriculture in the City of Surrey to improve food security, community engagement, and environmental sustainability.

Taking proactive measures to regulate wealth inequality for a better and healthier future of City of Surrey residents.

Provision for the facility of water mist cooling system at transit stops in Surrey during summer heatwaves could offer significant benefits for commuters.

Provision for drinking water fountains available in a safe and sanitary manner at public places throughout the City of Surrey.

Next Steps

The feedback collected from Phase 2 of the OCP engagement will help inform the next steps of the project development. In Phase 3, we will refine our project vision, values and building blocks, and identify key policy directions and detailed draft policy content. Engagement in this phase will include opportunities to help shape the policy work.

Learn More & Get Involved

- Visit surrey.ca/planning for general information on the Official Community Plan.
- Visit surrey.ca/ocp for engagement opportunities, updates or to ask questions online.
- Contact Don Buchanan by email - dbuchanan@surrey.ca or phone - 604.591.4619